Install Anaconda on macOS

ep-by-step guide with illustrative screenshots (Intel & Apple Silico

Prepared on August 25, 2025

Anaconda Download

https://www.anaconda.com/download

- One-click installer (.pkg) for macOS
- Choose Apple Silicon (arm64) or Intel (x86_64)

Before you start

- A Mac running macOS (Apple Silicon or Intel).
- Stable internet connection.
- ~5–10 GB free disk space (for Anaconda + environments).
- Admin password to complete installation.

Tip: If you're on Apple Silicon (M1/M2/M3/M4), prefer the 'arm64' installer.

About This Mac → Overview

Chip: Apple M-series (arm64) or Intel Core (x86_64)

Memory: 8 GB or more recommended

Storage: Ensure at least 10 GB free

Step 1 — Check your Mac's chip

Click → About This Mac → Overview.
Note whether you have a 'Chip' (Apple M-series/arm64) or 'Processor' (Intel/x86_64). You'll download the matching Anaconda installer in the next step.

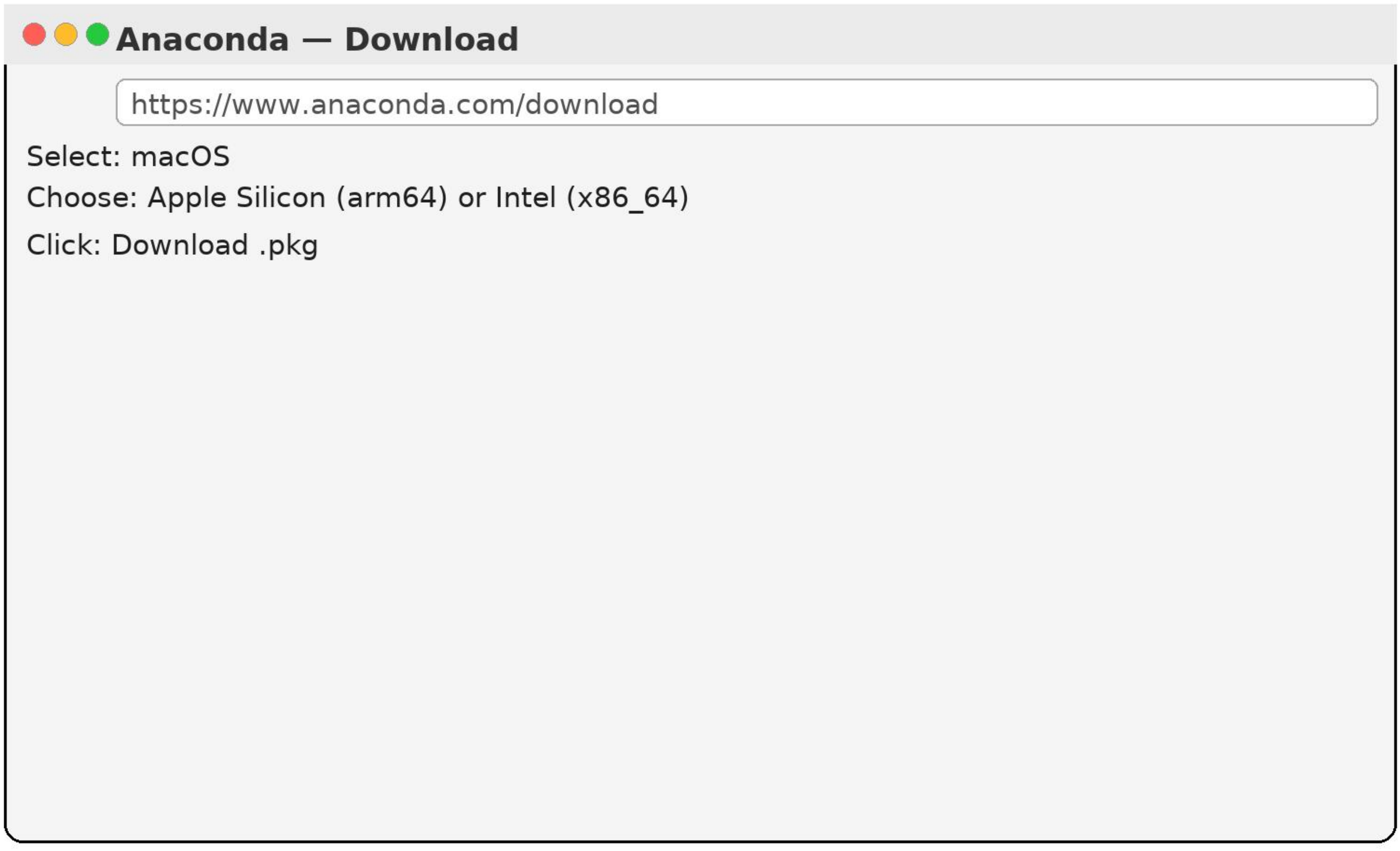
About This Mac

Chip: Apple M3 (arm64)

macOS: 14.x or later

Step 2 — Download the installer

Open your browser and go to the official Anaconda Download page. Choose macOS, then pick the installer that matches your chip:
• Apple Silicon → 'arm64' .pkg
• Intel → 'x86_64' .pkg
Click Download to save the file in your Downloads folder.



Step 3 — Open the .pkg file from Downloads

In Finder, open Downloads and double-click the Anaconda .pkg file to start the installer. The file name looks like:

- Anaconda3-<version>-MacOSX-arm64.pkg (Apple Silicon)
- Anaconda3-<version>-MacOSX-x86_64.pkg (Intel)

Finder — Downloads

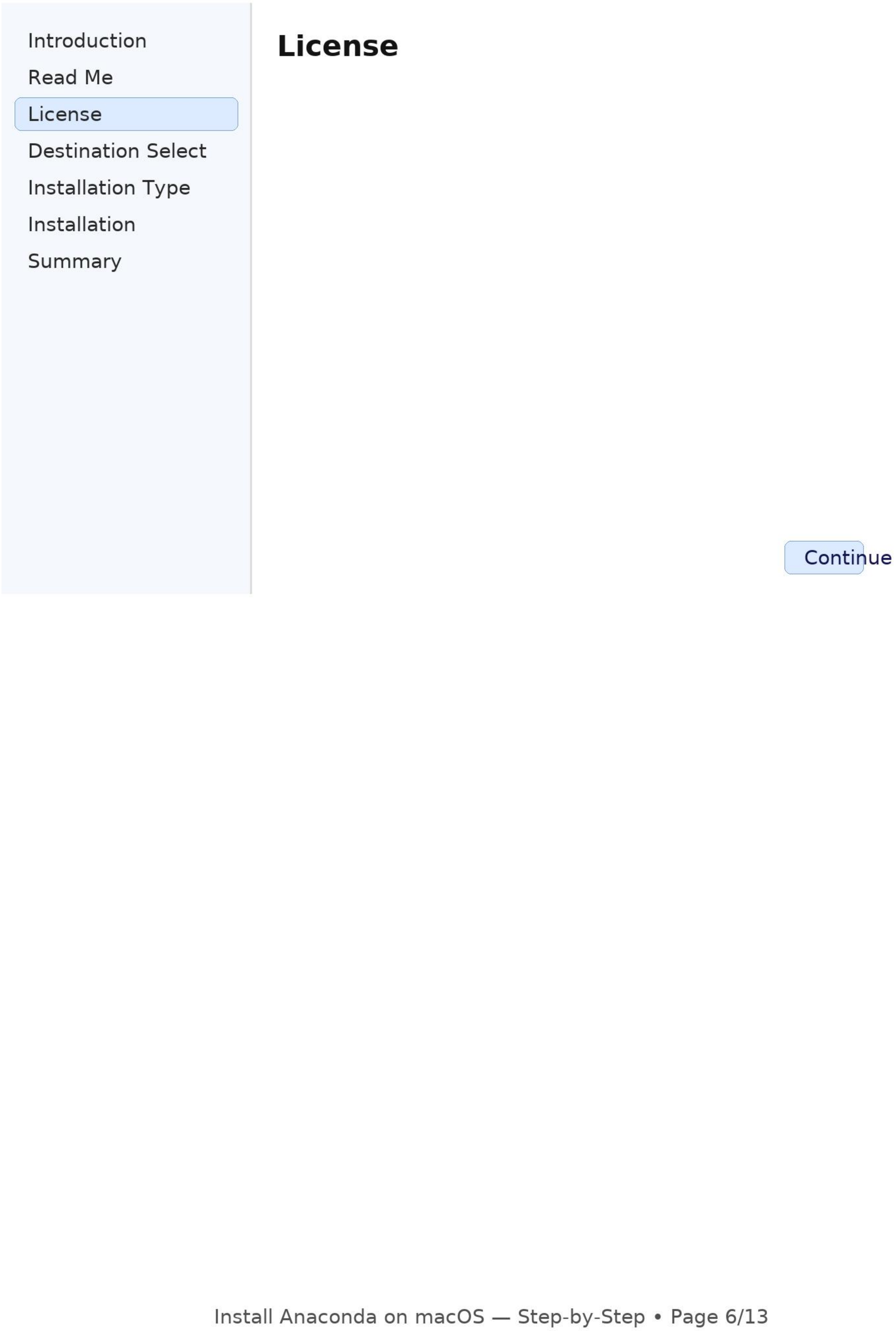
Anaconda3-2024.xx-MacOSX-arm64.pkg

Anaconda3-2024.xx-MacOSX-x86_64.pkg

Double-click to launch installer

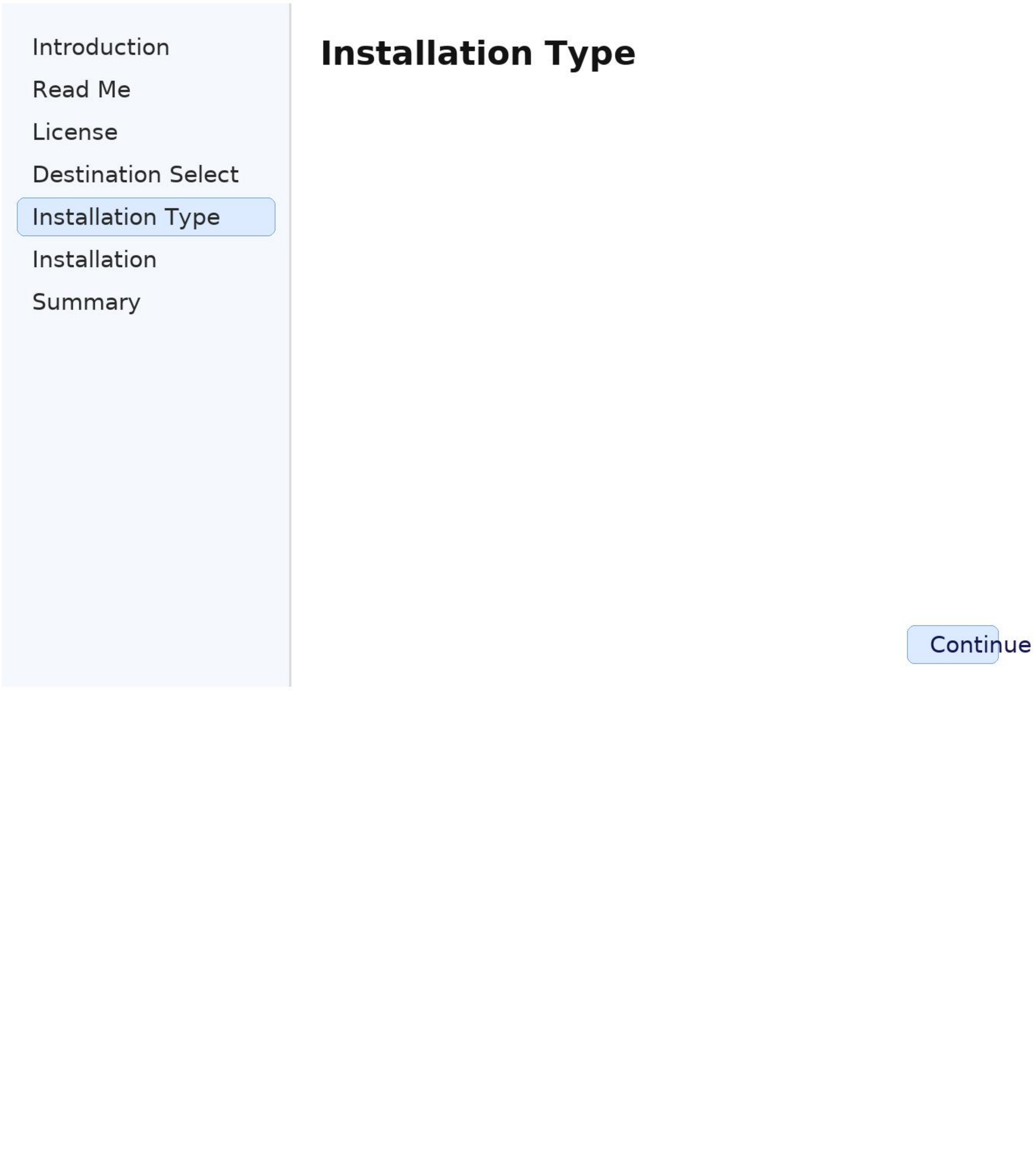
Step 4 — Introduction & License

Click Continue on Introduction and Read Me. Review the License, then click Continue → Agree to proceed.



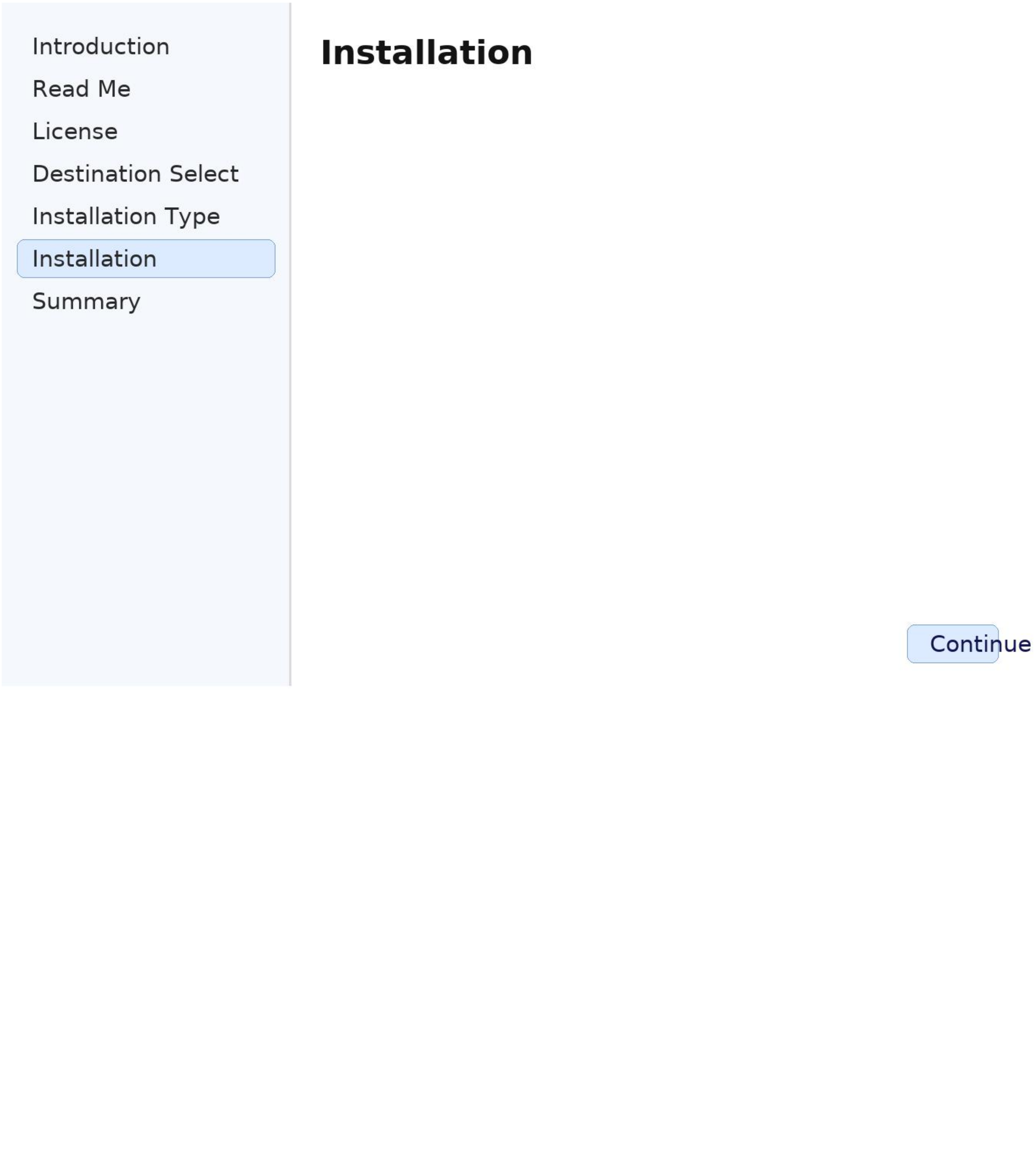
Step 5 — Destination & Installation Type

Choose the disk to install Anaconda (usually your main Macintosh HD). On Installation Type, you can click Install to accept defaults.



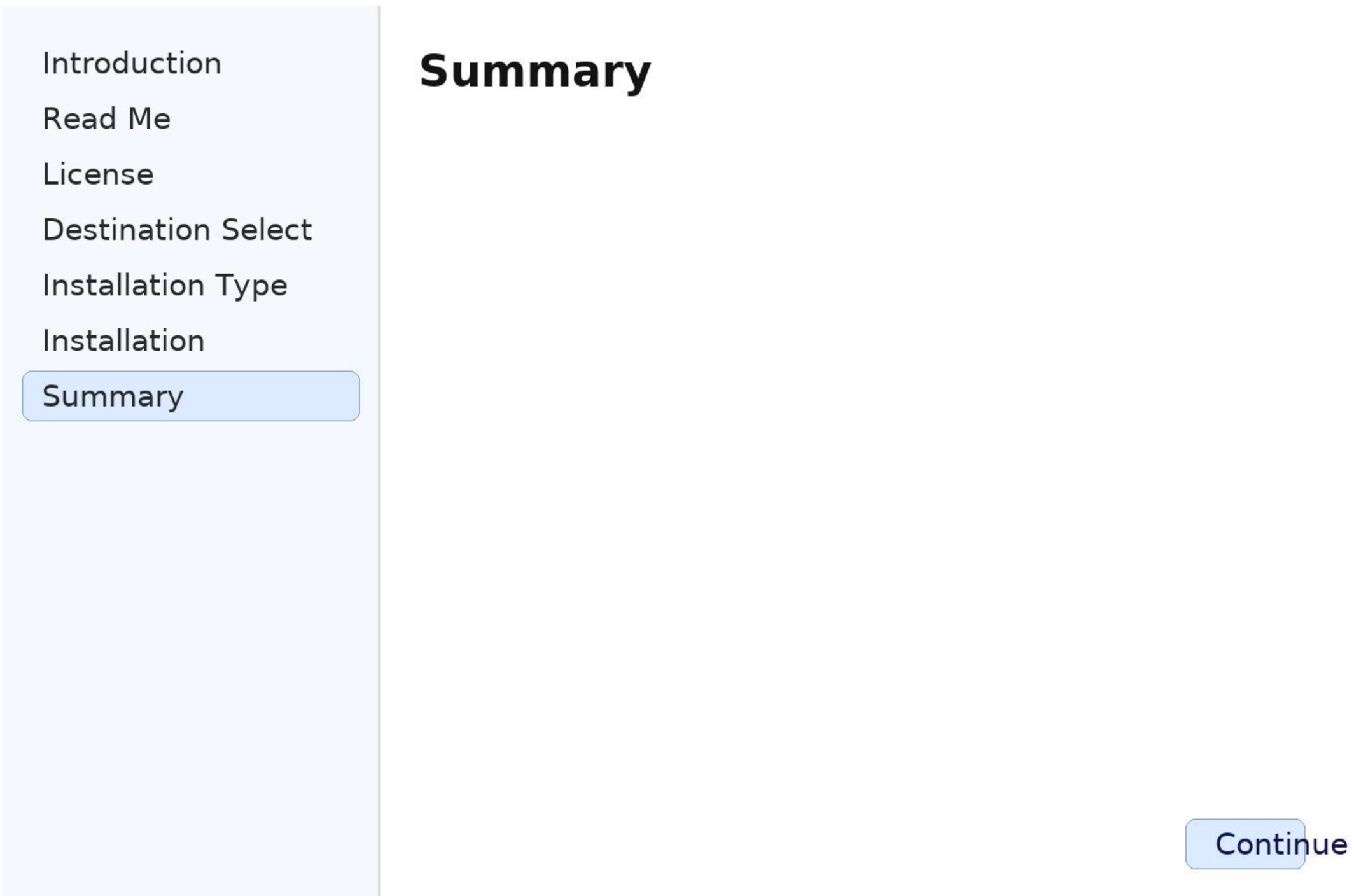
Step 6 — Install and authenticate

Click Install. Enter your macOS password if prompted. The installer will copy files and set up your base 'conda' environment.



Step 7 — Installation complete

When you see the Summary screen, click Close. Anaconda is now installed.



Step 8 — Initialize in Terminal (zsh)

Open Terminal (Applications → Utilities → Terminal). Run the following commands to initialize conda for zsh (the default macOS shell) and restart the terminal window:

```
$ conda init zsh
# Close and reopen Terminal
$ conda --version
conda 24.x.x
```

If 'conda' is not found, try starting a new Terminal window or run:

```
$ source ~/.zshrc
```

Step 9 — Create your first environment

Create an isolated Python environment and activate it. Example below creates Python 3.11:

```
$ conda create -n myenv python=3.11
$ conda activate myenv
(myenv) $ python --version
Python 3.11.x
```

Update conda and packages:

```
(myenv) $ conda update conda
(myenv) $ conda update --all
```

Step 10 — Launch Anaconda Navigator (optional)

Use Spotlight (⌘+Space) and type 'Anaconda Navigator' to launch the GUI. From here you can open tools like JupyterLab, VS Code, and manage environments.

Anaconda Navigator

Environments | Home | Learning

• Launch: JupyterLab • Launch: Spyder • Install: VS Code

• Create / Clone / Remove environments

Troubleshooting & Tips

• 'conda: command not found' → Close and reopen Terminal, or run `source ~/.zshrc`, or ensure Anaconda's path is added by `conda init`.
• Apple Silicon (arm64) vs Intel: Use the matching installer. On Apple Silicon, prefer native arm64 packages.
• Use separate environments per project to avoid dependency conflicts.
• To remove an environment: `conda remove -n myenv --all`.
• To uninstall Anaconda: remove the Anaconda folder (usually ~/anaconda3) and clean your shell init lines cautiously.

```
$ which conda
/Users/you/anaconda3/bin/conda
$ echo $SHELL
/bin/zsh
```

Step 11 — Launch Jupyter Notebook from Navigator

Anaconda Navigator makes it easy to launch Jupyter Notebook without using Terminal.

1. Open Anaconda Navigator from Spotlight (⌘+Space → 'Anaconda Navigator').
2. In the Home tab, locate Jupyter Notebook.
3. Click the 'Launch' button. A browser window will open at http://localhost:8888.
4. In the browser, click 'New → Python 3 (ipykernel)' to start a notebook.

You can now create and run Python code interactively.

Anaconda Navigator

[Home tab]

• JupyterLab — Launch

• Jupyter Notebook — Launch

• Spyder — Launch

Click 'Launch' next to Jupyter Notebook → Browser opens at localhost:8888

In browser: New → Python 3 → Notebook interface opens